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Curriculum Vitae

Education

Ph.D. Human-Centered Design and Engineering

Concentration: Human-Computer Interaction

Co-Advisors: Dr. Daniela K. Rosner, Dr. Katharina Reinecke

University of Washington (Expected: June 2027)

M.S. Human-Centered Design and Engineering

Co-Advisors: Dr. Daniela K. Rosner, Dr. Katharina Reinecke

University of Washington (December 2025)

M.S. Systems Engineering

Thesis: *"The SPORT-C Intervention: An Integration of Sports, Case-Based Pedagogy, and Systems Thinking Learning"*

Advisor: Dr. William Scherer

University of Virginia (May 2022)

B.S. Mechanical Engineering

Minor: Green Engineering

Virginia Polytechnic Institute and State University (May 2018)

Honors and Awards

2025	DEI Recognition — ACM Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (CSCW 2025)
2025	AFCEA Ralph W. Shrader Graduate Scholarship
2024	Social Action Term Fellowship in Human-Centered Design & Engineering
2023	Neon Blackboard Term Fellowship in Human-Centered Design & Engineering
2022	University of Washington College of Engineering Dean's Fellowship
2022	GOMAP Top Off Award, Graduate Student Equity & Excellence (GSEE)
2022	GEM Full Engineering Fellow, The National GEM Consortium and IBM – Ph.D.
2021	Inclusive Excellence Fellow
2021	National Society of Black Engineers Honors APEx Member
2020	GEM Full Engineering Fellow, The National GEM Consortium and Intel – M.S.
2020	Intel Scholar
2013	Virginia Tech Presidential Scholarship Initiative Recipient

Peer-Reviewed Publications

2026	Rosner, D. K., Barakat, H., Basoah, J. , Dogan, A. L., and Ghoshal, S. 2026. Data as Landed Property. Leonardo. https://doi.org/10.1162/LEON.a.2732
2026	Basoah, J. , Reinecke, K., Rosner, D., and Ogbonnaya-Ogburu, I. F. 2026. Hopeful Failure: How Collaborative Design Fiction Reimagines AI. In Proceedings of the 2026 ACM Designing Interactive Systems Conference (DIS '26). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA. https://doi.org/10.1145/3800645.3813092 [21% acceptance rate]
2026	Basoah, J. , Scherer, W., Boyd-Sinkler, K., and Bailey, R. In press. The SPORT-C Intervention: An Integration of Sports, Case-Based Pedagogy, and Systems Thinking Learning. In H. R. Arabia (Ed.), Proceedings of the 2026 International Conference on Applied Computing (CAC 2026). Springer Nature. https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.11755
2025	Cunningham, J. L., Adjagbodiu, A., Basoah, J. , Jawara, J., Kadoma, K., and Lewis, A. 2025. Toward Responsible ASR for African American English Speakers: A Scoping Review of Bias and Equity in Speech Technology. Proceedings of the AAAI/ACM Conference on AI, Ethics, and Society 8, 1 (October 2025), 665–678. https://doi.org/10.1609/aies.v8i1.36580 [34.7% acceptance rate]

- 2025 **Basoah, J.**, Chechelnitsky, D., Long, T., Reinecke, K., Zerva, C., Zhou, K., Díaz, M., and Sap, M. 2025. Not Like Us, Hunty: Measuring Perceptions and Behavioral Effects of Minoritized Anthropomorphic Cues in LLMs. In Proceedings of the 2025 ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (FAccT '25). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 710–745. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3715275.3732045> [26.8% acceptance rate]
- 2025 **Basoah, J.**, Cunningham, J. L., Adams, E., Bose, A., Jain, A., Yadav, K., Yang, Z., Reinecke, K., and Rosner, D. 2025. Should AI Mimic People? Understanding AI-Supported Writing Technology Among Black Users. Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction 9, CSCW3, Article 242 (November 2025), 51 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3757423> [journal-style peer review with an effective selectivity of ~15-20%] **[DEI Award recipient]**

Press and Industry Writing

- 2026 Dwyer, H., **Basoah, J.**, & Wang, J. (2026, January 27). When AI joins the team: Three principles for responsible agent design. Microsoft Design. <https://microsoft.design/articles/principles-for-responsible-agent-design/>

Research Experience

Tactile and Tactical Design Lab x Wildlab | University of Washington | Graduate Research Assistant | September 2022 – Present

Not Like Us, Hunty: Measuring Perceptions and Behavioral Effects of Minoritized Anthropomorphic Cues in LLMs | Role: Lead Researcher | April 2024 – January 2025

- Designed and executed two large-scale user studies (n=985) examining whether LLM sociolect usage affects user reliance and perception among African American English (AAE) and Queer slang speakers.
- Recruited and coordinated 498 AAE speakers and 487 Queer slang speakers across counterbalanced question-answering tasks comparing LLM agents in Standard American English (SAE) vs. self-identified sociolect conditions.
- Found that both AAE and Queer slang speakers relied more on and held more positive perceptions of the SAE agent, while Queer slang speakers uniquely reported greater social presence from the sociolect agent, surfacing meaningful divergence across minoritized communities.
- Demonstrated the need to measure behavioral outcomes rather than assuming personalization leads to improved reliance and safety, challenging a dominant assumption in adaptive AI design.
- Published in *Proceedings of the 2025 ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency* (FAccT '25); 26.8% acceptance rate.

Hopeful Failure: How Collaborative Design Fiction Reimagines AI | Role: Lead Researcher | January 2023 – October 2023

- Developed "Exquisite Tellings," a novel participatory storytelling method, and facilitated collaborative design fiction workshops with 10 Black American participants to center marginalized voices in speculative AI futures.
- Synthesized workshop narratives to surface five engagement axes with AI that blend acceptance and resistance, moving beyond binary optimism/pessimism framings dominant in prior HCI and futures research.
- Demonstrated that collective design fiction, balancing individual agency with shared imagination, can generate community-centered visions of AI that reflect the complexity of marginalized communities' lived experiences.
- Introduced a replicable methodological contribution to participatory HCI, expanding the toolkit available for inclusive speculative design research.
- Accepted to ACM Designing Interactive Systems (DIS 2026); 21% acceptance rate.

Should AI Mimic People? Understanding AI-Supported Writing Technology Among Black Users | Role: Lead Researcher | January 2023 – October 2023

- Designed and conducted a two-phase qualitative study examining how Black American users experience AI-supported writing technologies, combining 13 semi-structured interviews with a remote-moderated user study of Google Docs and ChatGPT.
- Synthesized findings across participants to document expectations, apprehensions, and perceptions of NLP tools among Black American users, contributing empirical grounding to an underexamined population in HCI research.
- Uncovered a novel concern absent from prior literature: the potential for AI-driven gradual erasure of Black American cultural expression as future generations increasingly depend on AI for information.

- Published in Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction (CSCW 2025); journal-style peer review with an effective selectivity of ~15–20%.

The Sports Analytics Club Program | Mixed-Methods Researcher | February 2021 – May 2022

The SPORT-C Intervention: An Integration of Sports, Case-Based Pedagogy and Systems Thinking Learning

- Designed and deployed Qualtrics surveys across multiple classrooms to measure academic engagement, self-efficacy, expectancy, value, and cost among underrepresented STEM students, generating preliminary data to guide sports-integrated curriculum development.
- Conducted qualitative usability tests with 2 classrooms to assess the impact of sports-related case studies on student learning experiences, directly aligning case development iterations with student feedback.
- Synthesized mixed-methods findings and communicated insights to an interdisciplinary research team, ensuring the curriculum development roadmap addressed all 4 stakeholder goals and tracked relevant engagement metrics.
- Accepted to *Springer Nature CAC 2026* proceedings

Monumental Sports and Entertainment | Data Analyst | January 2021 – March 2021

Fired Fairly? Examining Racial Disparities in NCAA Football Coaching Positions

- Identified and framed a critical racial imbalance in college football — where African Americans constitute nearly 50% of FBS players but hold less than 10% of head coaching positions — and designed a large-scale quantitative study to examine whether racial bias drives minority coach firing decisions.
- Applied classical and exploratory data analysis techniques including linear regression, binary regression, ANOVA, and T-tests to a longitudinal dataset of 200 NCAA coaches spanning a decade, using Minitab for hypothesis testing and regression model construction.
- Synthesized complex statistical findings into accessible data visualizations and presented results to 20 MBA executives in an educational workshop, communicating evidence of racial bias in NCAA coaching hiring and firing practices.

Teaching Experience

Computer Ethics (CSE 581)

Graduate Teaching Assistant | Winter 2026 | *University of Washington*

- Facilitated weekly graduate-level seminar discussions on ethics in computing, engaging students across CS, HCDE, and information science in critical analysis of algorithmic fairness, AI accountability, and responsible technology design.
- Mentored 6+ student research teams through a quarter-long independent ethics research project, guiding proposal development, research design, and fairness/justice-oriented analysis culminating in a publishable-style paper (4–6 pages) and poster presentation.
- Provided formative feedback on student work at the intersection of technical systems and social impact, drawing on ongoing scholarship in AI sociolinguistic bias and minoritized user experiences to ground seminar discussions in active scholarship.

Capstone Planning (HCDE492), Senior Capstone (HCDE493)

Graduate Teaching Assistant | Winter 2024 - Spring 2024, Spring 2025 | *University of Washington*

- Facilitated discussions and group activities during class sessions for over 70 students to enhance learning and engagement.
- Served as a mentor for 4 4-person industry-sponsored capstone groups over the course of two quarters, promoting academic integrity, professionalism, and ethical behavior.
- Conducted review sessions and provided guidance to students on course concepts, assignments, and capstone milestones.

System Evaluation (SYS3034)

Graduate Teaching Assistant | Spring 2021, Spring 2022 | *University of Virginia*

- Provided academic support and instruction to 60 students in undergraduate level course.
- Facilitated classroom discussion sessions and held weekly office hours to provide tutoring, counseling, or assistance to students in need.
- Contributed to the development of appropriate teaching materials to ensure content and methods of delivery met learning objectives.

Intro to Systems Analysis & Design (SYS6001)

- Delivered comprehensive academic support and instruction to a cohort of 30 graduate-level students, ensuring a conducive learning environment and fostering intellectual growth.
- Collaborated with faculty members to facilitate lectures, evaluate student performance, and conduct grading assessments, contributing to the overall success of the instructional team.

Professional Experience

Microsoft | Design Researcher, Intern | June 2026 – September 2026

- Uncovered a previously unrecognized pattern in how users delegate work to AI agents across 3 product lines; revealed critical gaps in control, accountability, and human oversight requirements.
- Finding prompted the Cowork and Scout teams to reprioritize human-in-the-loop interactions and informed new thinking on agent-to-person coordination with Microsoft's future of work researchers.
- Shaped the Q2 product roadmap for Cowork and Scout by translating user research into product requirements for human sign-off, ownership, and intervention in higher-stakes AI workflows.
- Extended work beyond the immediate product teams by contributing research principles to Microsoft's organization-wide human-AI collaboration framework, helping establish scalable boundaries for when AI agents should act autonomously versus defer to people.

Microsoft | Design Researcher, Intern | June 2025 – September 2025

- Led foundational research shaping mid- to long-term AI UX strategy for Microsoft's Agent 365 initiative, focusing on risks and design opportunities around personified, agentic AI and AI-powered digital workers.
- Reviewed 30+ academic research papers and public debate on agentic AI; distilled insights into a taxonomy of 14 organizational, group, and individual-level risks.
- Mapped 14 risks to existing and emergent design mitigation tactics; produced a scalable risk-to-mitigation framework adopted into BIC's Responsible AI design strategy.
- Prioritized 3 critical risks for immediate mitigation; partnered with Agent 365 team to prototype design principle cards deployed to AI UX teams across BIC.
- Presented strategic recommendations to BIC's Corporate Vice President, global design organization, and company-wide Aether v-team; shaped responsible deployment of agentic AI across Microsoft 365 and Dynamics ecosystems.
- Findings were adopted by Microsoft's Office of Responsible AI into company-wide policy and governance frameworks for AI agent design, culminating in a co-authored publication on Microsoft Design: When AI Joins the Team: Three Principles for Responsible Agent Design.

IBM Corporation | User Experience Researcher, Senior Intern | January 2024 – August 2024

- Initiated and implemented a company-wide program spanning 6+ client accounts to identify challenges across multiple clients, with a focus on improving user experience and engagement.
- Drove a 14% UMUX score improvement within 6 months; developed a strategic mixed-methods plan combining usability testing and design critiques to pinpoint and address key friction areas.
- Identified 2 previously unrecognized user segments for IBM z/OSMF through in-depth interviews and usability sessions, expanding the product team's understanding of who their primary users actually were.
- Translated user segment findings into targeted design priorities, directly shaping UI and product feature development roadmap iterations for z/OSMF.

IBM Corporation | User Experience Researcher, Senior Intern | June 2023 – September 2023

- Analyzed 20+ customer feedback responses bi-weekly during product beta testing; surfaced key highlights and challenges that aligned product development priorities for an upcoming release.
- Distilled 100+ user comments into 5 generative research workshops; sessions surfaced foundational user grievances with product release and shaped product development priorities.
- Oversaw 15+ internal interviews examining impact of 2 distinct visual frameworks on client adoption; derived 7 evidence-based insights feeding directly into exploratory customer research aimed at increasing product adoption.

IBM Corporation | User Experience Researcher, Intern | May 2022 – December 2022

- Ran 2 heuristic evaluations of IBM z/OSMF by assessing primary end-to-end user flows across 2 personas; flagged 20 improvement points within user flows.

- Partnered with UX Designer to architect 2 Airtable databases and sponsor user feedback forms; streamlined user experience feedback capture and integration with client feedback processes.
- Administered 6 usability tests on sponsor users alongside UX Designer; built affinity map from results and communicated findings to three-in-a-box team.
- Deployed an on-platform CSAT survey to 200+ z/OSMF users; generated actionable satisfaction and usability data fed directly into product improvement roadmap.

Intel Corporation | Process Engineer | August 2018 – August 2020

- Modeled and assessed tool trends of over 150 tools to predict and identify potential unscheduled downtime using Statistical Process Control (SPC) system.
- Launched a daily report for the SCC toolset tracking and monitoring matching discrepancies across 3 tools, led to biweekly optimization of all tool's measured layers.
- Revamped disposition system for REG valid data failures toolset to maintain seamless data review and communication throughout all 4 shifts and command center.
- Chaired project formed to reduce quarterly spending for DPCdc, reduced spending by an average of \$6000 per quarter while doubling allocated annual budget.
- Managed and investigated equipment failures of 7 tools, diagnosed faulty operation and incorporated learnings into procedures to anticipate future equipment issues.
- Shaped DPCdc availability roadmap; tool availability improved from an annual average of 86% to 94% as tool owner.

Ford Motor Company | Stamping Coordinator, Intern | May 2016 – August 2016

- Developed visual aids and single point lessons for new control point process verification system, increasing quality of stamped panels by 25%.
- Implemented verification system into assembly line, educated & coached 20 Tool & Die staff in proper procedure.

Leadership

2022 – Present	Design Team Lead - A Vision for Engineering Literacy & Access (AVELA)
2022 – 2023	Professional Development Program Committee Member - National Society of Black Engineers (NSBE)
2021 – 2022	Program Assistant - Men/Women of Color, Honor, and Ambition (M.O.C.H.A./W.O.C.H.A)
2017 – Present	Co-Founder - Acquiring Knowledge for Transcendence, Inc.
2015 – 2016	Senator - National Society of Black Engineers (Virginia Tech)

Grants

2026	University of Washington Human Centered Design & Engineering Doctoral Research Grant – Awarded ~\$400 ◦ Designed to support HCDE PhD students who need assistance to carry out research that advances their progress toward their degree.
2026	University of Washington Human Centered Design & Engineering Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Grant – Awarded ~\$400 ◦ Support grassroots diversity, equity, and inclusion initiatives within the department. Proposals can cover a wide range of community building, group training, and other DEI-related efforts.
2023	University of Washington Human Centered Design & Engineering Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Grant – Awarded ~\$700 ◦ Support grassroots diversity, equity, and inclusion initiatives within the department. Proposals can cover a wide range of community building, group training, and other DEI-related efforts.
2023	University of Washington Human Centered Design & Engineering Doctoral Research Grant – Awarded ~\$1400 ◦ Designed to support HCDE PhD students who need assistance to carry out research that advances their progress toward their degree.

Invited Talks and Panels

2026	Panelist – Stealing My Magic: Data, Agency, and the Future of Black Communities in the AI Era (Seattle Black Nerd Festival)
2026	Guest Lecture - Inclusive Design and Engineering (Winter Quarter)
2025	Guest Lecture - Inclusive Design and Engineering (Winter Quarter)
2024	Guest Lecture - Inclusive Design and Engineering (Winter Quarter)

2022 **Presenter** - The 18th International Conference on Frontiers in Education: Computer Science & Computer Engineering
 2021 **Panelist** - Navigating & Maximizing Professional Conferences
 2021 **Presenter** - Darden Executive MBA Course: Data Analytics and Leadership Judgment in Sports
 2020 **Panelist** - Tapia Conference: Secure Your Bag(s) & Degree(s): Graduate School Edition

Professional & Service Activities

Reviewer Work

2026 ACM Designing Interactive Systems (DIS 2026)
 2025 - 2026 ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI 2026)

Department Service

2024 **PhD Admissions Review Committee**, University of Washington Human-Centered Design & Engineering
 2023 – Present **PhD Student Ambassador**, University of Washington Human-Centered Design & Engineering
 2023 **PhD Admissions Review Committee**, University of Washington Human-Centered Design & Engineering

Involvement and Community Engagement

2022 – Present **Member/Outreaching Grad** - Graduate Student Equity & Excellence (GSEE) - University of Washington
 2022 – Present **Member** - Black Graduate Student Association (BGSA) - University of Washington
 2017 – Present **Board of Director, Education Outreach** - Acquiring Knowledge for Transcendence, Inc

Conferences

2026 ACM Designing Interactive Systems (DIS 2026)
 2025 The 28th ACM Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (CSCW 2025)
 2025 AAAI/ACM Conference on AI, Ethics, and Society (AIES 2025)
 2025 ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (FAcT 2025)
 2023 ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI 2023)
 2022 The 18th International Conference on Frontiers in Education: Computer Science & Computer Engineering
 2022 GEM Annual Board Meeting and Conference
 2022 NSBE National Convention
 2021 CMD-IT/ACM Richard Tapia Celebration of Diversity in Computing Conference
 2021 NSBE Fall Regional Conference - Region 2
 2021 AfroTech Conference
 2021 Black is Tech Conference
 2021 GEM Annual Board Meeting and Conference
 2020 CMD-IT/ACM Richard Tapia Celebration of Diversity in Computing Conference
 2013 – 2018 NSBE National Convention and Fall Regional 2 Conference

Skills

Qualitative Research

- Semi Structured Interviews, Remote Moderated Usability Testing, Heuristic Evaluation, Usability Testing, Affinity Mapping, Experimental Design, Stakeholder Walkthrough, Survey Design, Participatory Design/ Co-Design Facilitation, Thematic Analysis

Quantitative Research

- Linear Regression, Binary Regression, Hypothesis Testing, Chi-Square, ANOVA, T-Test, Power Analysis, Correlation, Within-Subjects Experimental Design, Between-Subjects Experimental Design, Psychometric Scale Development and Adaptation,

Project Management

- Multi-Phase Study Design and Execution, Research Timeline and Milestone Management, Cross-Institutional Research Collaboration, Grant Writing and Reporting, Research Budget Management, Stakeholder Communication and Research Translation

Analytical Tools

- Minitab, Tableau, Power BI, Qualtrics, Airtable, Advanced Microsoft Excel, Overleaf

Programming Languages

- R/RStudio, LaTeX